Zahir Ali

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Summary

Data Analyst at Euromonitor International building forecasting and statistical models behind published data products (Passport) and client consulting work. I take loosely defined problems end to end: scoping the ask, wrangling messy multi-source data in SQL/BigQuery, modelling in R and Python, testing results against business logic, and handing over reproducible pipelines. Background in Computer Science and Economics; I use AI coding assistants daily to ship faster.

Experience

Data Analyst – Analytics Team Jul 2025 – Present

Euromonitor International *Bengaluru, Karnataka*

- Scoped and co-developed a **cohort survival model** in R forecasting GLP-1 medication users and ex-users to 2035, with drop-off and restart flows, calibration to external analyst estimates, and simulation-based bull/base/bear ranges; turned a stakeholder's Excel prototype into a reproducible, version-controlled pipeline.
- Built the **Average Length of Stay** forecasting pipeline for 43,890 travel corridors: out-of-sample-validated gravity models with automated per-corridor model selection (MAPE, pseudo-R^2, sign consistency, mean reversion), flagging weak corridors for analyst review; designed the topline-scaling step (soft bounds, rank and trend preservation); co-authored the methodology documentation.
- Analysed **AI-referred shopping journeys** for a global FMCG client on 4.8M clickstream sessions in BigQuery: built session, 24-hour purchase-journey and post-referral transition tables; caught and corrected a brand-attribution error (supplier-table join misclassifying competitor brands) by moving to a curated brand×category mapping.
- Validated **econometric channel-share driver models** across multiple countries, checking coefficient signs and economic logic to reject statistically good but economically implausible specifications.
- Maintain R forecasting pipelines (ARIMA, BSTS, Panel) powering Passport, using internal AI agents for driver validation and variable grouping; automate API-based economic data extraction in Python.
- Write structured build specs for **GitHub Copilot** to scaffold and refactor model pipelines, then review and test the generated code.

Associate Research Analyst – Catalyst Team Jul 2024 – Jul 2025

Euromonitor International *Bengaluru, Karnataka*

- Supported development of internal data apps serving 100+ monthly expert-interview transcripts to research and LLM summarisation workflows; extended a **REST API** (e.g. expanding coverage to pre-2023 trade interviews) and shared endpoints with stakeholders.
- Contributed to ETL pipelines combining automated Salesforce API pulls and batch VTT transcript processing into a unified schema, and helped track ingestion KPIs (frequency, distribution, quality) for cross-functional stakeholders.
- Worked within the team's **GitLab CI/CD** deployment setup on a VM, helping automate recurring data operations.

Graduate Teaching Fellow & Research Assistant Aug 2023 – May 2024

Ashoka University *Sonipat, Haryana*

- Built Python (Selenium) pipelines for multi-source extraction of public policy datasets.
- Taught R, statistics and econometrics to 50+ undergraduates across two data science courses (Rating: 4.8/5).

Technical Skills

Languages & Data: Python (Pandas, Scikit-learn, Streamlit), R (tidyverse, plm, Shiny), SQL (BigQuery, MySQL)
Modelling: Time-Series (ARIMA, BSTS), Panel & Regression Econometrics, Gravity Models, Survival/Cohort Models, Simulation-based Scenarios, Out-of-sample Model Evaluation & Selection
AI & Engineering: ETL Pipelines, Web-Scraping, Git, GitLab CI/CD, Azure DevOps, Azure VMs, GitHub Copilot
Visualisation: Shiny, Streamlit, Plotly

Education

Ashoka University Sep 2022 – May 2023

PG.D., Concentration in Economics *CGPA: 3.43/4*

Ashoka University Aug 2019 – May 2022

Bachelor of Science – Psychology & Computer Science; Dean's List (4 semesters) *CGPA: 3.63/4*

Projects

Decision Support | *Python – Data Mining, Clustering, Sentiment Analysis*